



المرصد الاجتماعي
THE SOCIAL OBSERVATORY
L'OBSERVATOIRE SOCIAL
Think. Observe. Anticipate. Act.

**We facilitate social
transformation and every
transformation begins
with understanding
people.**

Shifting insights into trust-based societies and dignity for all

A. Our Purpose

Morocco and Africa are entering one of the most significant periods of social transformation in modern history. By 2050, Africa will be home to nearly one-quarter of the world's population — more than 2.5 billion people and the largest youth generation ever recorded. Rapid urbanization, technological disruption, climate pressures, migration, evolving labor markets, changing gender dynamics, and rising expectations for participation and accountability are reshaping societies at unprecedented speed.

Yet institutions often struggle to anticipate what these transformations truly imply. They lack the spaces and fora to explore how change translates into people's representation and course of action. As a result, public policies are too often designed with short-sighted perspectives, incomplete social data, and an impoverished understanding of people's lived realities.

Meanwhile, decision-makers face growing complexity. They openly report the difficulty of meeting citizens' rising demand for solutions that are inclusive, evidence-based, and responsive to local contexts.

This reveals a critical gap: public institutions need stronger internal capacities — and credible third parties — able to read emerging trends, interpret social change, and turn knowledge into action. Without robust social intelligence, foresight, and territorial understanding, opportunities are missed, inequalities deepen, and public trust erodes further.

The Social Observatory exists to close this gap. Across Africa, many actors already generate social insight — but they rarely operate as an integrated, self-aware ecosystem. Our role is to connect them: to broaden social dialogue, produce shared foresight, and run the social laboratories needed to move from fear and social contempt to bold, informed action. For us, societal transformation means shared opportunity and trust-based societies for all.



The Social Observatory is a non-partisan association conceived as a **Think & Do Tank**, headquartered in Casablanca, Morocco, and working across the African continent. Its work unfolds in two movements — **the Think Tank** (how we think) and **the Do Tank** (how we act) — around a single constant: social progress.



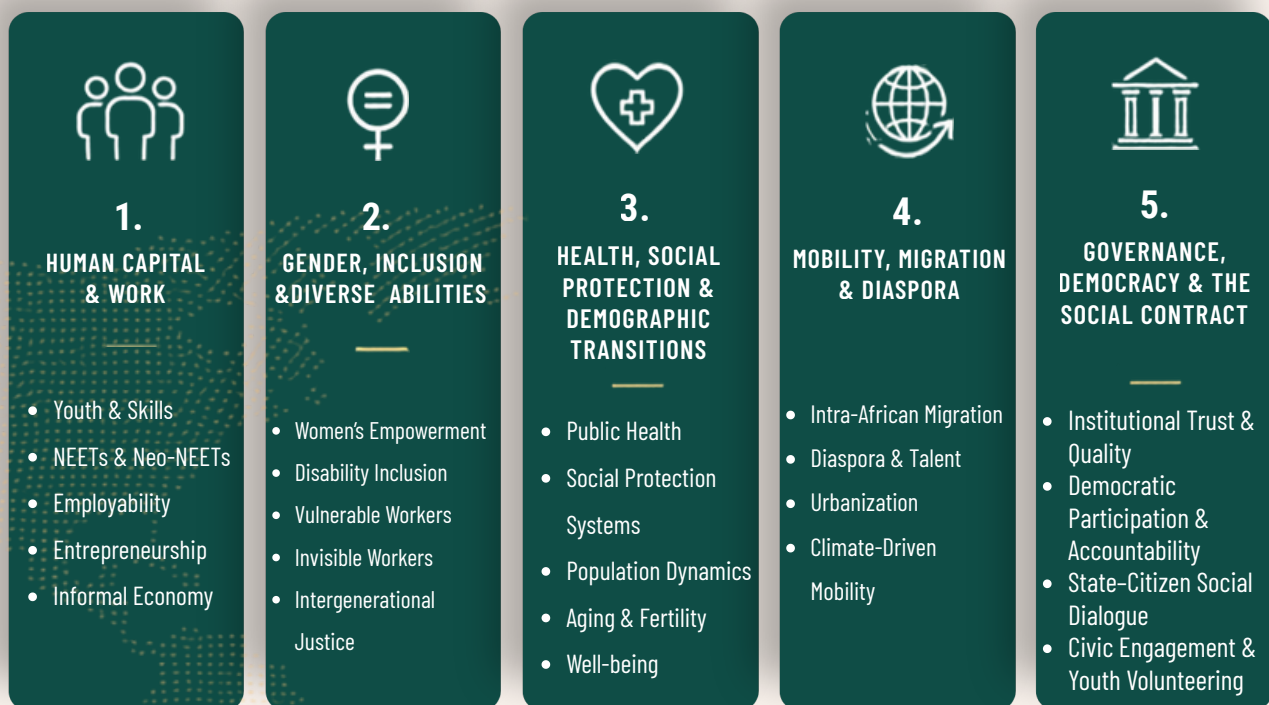
B. Our Thematic Focus

Our work is organized around one constant, five thematic pillars, and three cross-cutting forces. This architecture defines what we study — and keeps our attention on the issues that will shape the continent through 2050, rather than on any single agenda.

The constant — Social Progress

Every stream of our work serves one end: measurable social progress dignity, cohesion, and shared opportunity. We track it through an African Social Progress Barometer, our recurring flagship instrument.

The five thematic pillars — what we study



The three cross-cutting forces — how we read every pillar

Technology & Artificial Intelligence

reshaping work, public services, information, and digital inclusion across every theme.

Climate & Sustainability

a structural driver of migration, food security, green jobs, and environmental health.

A Territorial Approach

the same issue never reads the same from one territory to another place is our systematic lens. Gender is also applied as a mainstreamed analytical lens across all five pillars, in addition to being a pillar in its own right.

C. The Think Tank — How We Think

The four disciplines through which we read and interpret social change.

We place people's lived experiences, needs, and aspirations at the center of policy design, program development, and social innovation. Our approach is human-centered and combines four complementary disciplines that turn social understanding into meaningful action.

The four disciplines through which we read and interpret social change.

1. Social Intelligence Insights

We generate robust evidence through qualitative and quantitative research, ensuring decisions are grounded in reliable data, diverse perspectives, and scientific rigor. We identify, analyze, and interpret the social dynamics, behaviors, aspirations, and emerging trends that shape societies and influence decision-making. Across all our thematic pillars, we place particular focus on the realities, community assets, and vulnerabilities of territories, to support place-based strategies that respond to local needs.

2. Social Dialogue

We work to broaden the very notion of social dialogue. In its conventional, ESG-related sense, social dialogue refers to consultation, negotiation, and cooperation between employers, employees, and their representatives on issues of work and working conditions. We extend it in two directions: first, to include invisible work and invisible workers — namely women and vulnerable populations; and second, to encompass the dialogue between the State and populations on specific social issues — the conversation between institutions and the citizens they serve. We explore possible futures for the professionalization of vulnerable populations, detect weak signals of change, and help both public institutions and private organizations anticipate challenges before they emerge.

3. Social Advocacy & Campaigns

We translate knowledge into influence by raising awareness of critical social issues. Our key findings are curated into clear, accessible messaging that sparks public debate, making knowledge usable and relevant for decision-makers, media, practitioners, and communities.

4. Social Audit & Social Progress Assessment

We distinguish two complementary practices for two different audiences. Social Audit serves enterprises: an evaluation of their social responsibility, practices, and performance. Social Progress Audit & Assessment serves non-profits, governments, cooperation agencies, and third parties: an evaluation of the outcomes, effectiveness, and long-term impact of policies, programs, and investments — understanding not only what works, but why, for whom, and under what conditions. In both cases we create learning loops that turn findings into actionable insight, helping organizations be reflexive and improve over time.

D. The Do Tank — How We Act

How we turn that reading into knowledge, capacity, and connection.

Meaningful social transformation requires more than diagnosis. Our work unfolds in three movements — producing knowledge, building capacity, and connecting actors to accelerate progress.

D.1 Knowledge Production

Flagship social reports — rigorous, accessible analyses of the major social transformations affecting Morocco and African societies, drawing on quantitative data, field research, citizen perspectives, and international benchmarks, with particular attention to weak signals and emerging risks before they escalate into large-scale challenges.

Territorial social dashboards — interactive platforms combining official statistics, citizen-generated data, community feedback, and local observation to give decision-makers real-time insight into social conditions, disparities, and progress toward inclusion, while encouraging citizen participation in local governance.

Foresight & prospective studies — scenario planning, trend analysis, expert consultation, and participatory foresight to help governments, foundations, corporations, and development partners prepare for demographic, technological, climatic, and labor-market shifts.

Annual impact & policy briefs — yearly briefs assessing the impact of the public policies, philanthropic investments, and social-innovation initiatives we conduct, capturing lessons learned and highlighting scalable practices.

D.2 Capacity Building

Public policy design & evaluation — supporting public institutions, local governments, foundations, and development actors in designing evidence-based, citizen-centered, outcome-oriented policies, combining policy research, stakeholder engagement, behavioral insight, impact measurement, and implementation support.

Social innovation labs — safe environments for experimentation where entrepreneurs, public institutions, youth organizations, and community leaders test responses to challenges such as youth unemployment, educational inequality, and civic participation; successful pilots are documented, evaluated, and prepared for scaling.

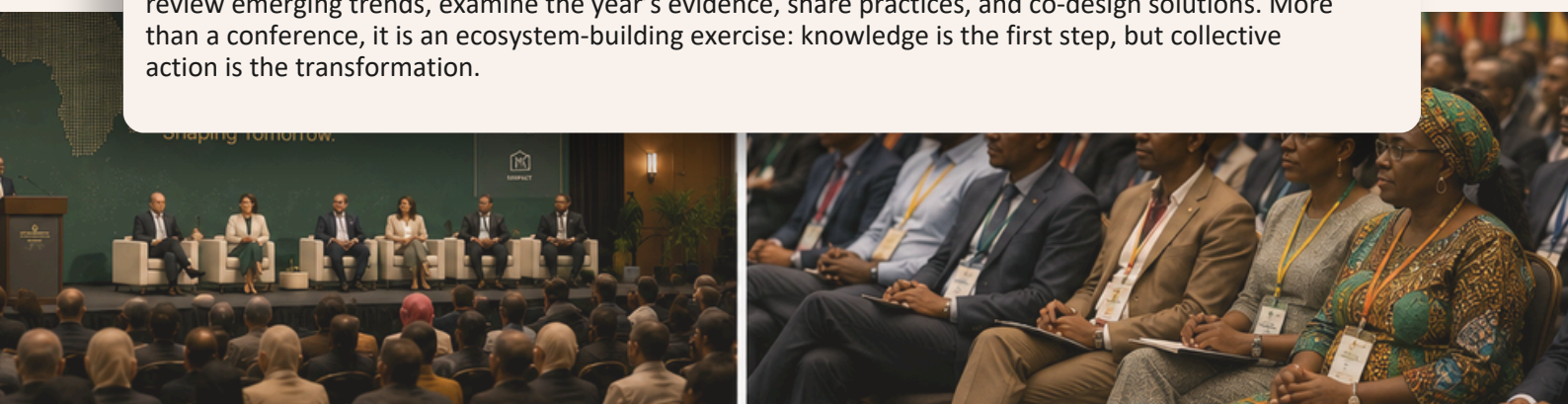
Youth civic-leadership bootcamps — immersive programs in underserved communities across Morocco and the continent, building leadership, critical thinking, project management, and social-entrepreneurship skills, and turning young people from beneficiaries into drivers of change.

Gender equality & women's leadership — gender-sensitive policy analysis, leadership-development programs, research on barriers to women's participation, and evidence-based solutions for women's economic, social, and civic empowerment.

D.3 Accelerating Social Progress through Connection

Advocacy initiatives — campaigns that turn research findings into policy recommendations, public debate, and collective mobilization, convening decision-makers, journalists, practitioners, academics, community leaders, and citizens around critical issues through policy dialogues, strategic communications, media engagement, and coalition building.

The Annual Forum for Social Intelligence — our flagship annual gathering, bringing together government, civil society, researchers, entrepreneurs, businesses, donors, media, and citizens to review emerging trends, examine the year's evidence, share practices, and co-design solutions. More than a conference, it is an ecosystem-building exercise: knowledge is the first step, but collective action is the transformation.



E. Our Productions

Flagship social reports — our regular evidence base on the continent's social transformations. First titles in the series:

"A Generation on Hold: When Africa's Youth Questions Our Collective Future — The Case of Morocco" (Human Capital & Work);

- "Aging in North Africa: The Family Facing the Demographic Transition — Cross-Perspectives from Morocco, Tunisia, and Egypt" (Health, Social Protection & Demographic Transitions);
- "The Invisible Commitment: Youth Volunteering, an Overlooked Lever for Socio-Economic Inclusion in Africa — The Case of Morocco" (Governance, Democracy & the Social Contract).



Foresight & prospective studies — forward-looking analyses to 2050 on demographic, technological, climatic, and labor-market change.

- "The Neo-NEET Transition: A Pan-African Pathway to Empower 70 Million Young People by 2050" (Governance, Democracy & the Social Contract).

Annual impact & policy briefs — yearly assessments of the policies, investments, and initiatives we conduct.



Le Maroc Social 2030 — a flagship publication of the Observatory, articulating a territorialized vision of social progress and policy directions for youth, gender, intergenerational justice, and the social contract in service of human dignity.



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